ENG519 Mid-Term Current Papers Solution

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1. Define Syllabus Design.

Syllabus design is the process of developing a syllabus. A syllabus is seen as a specification of the content of a course of instruction and lists all possible teaching content. Thus, the syllabus for a speaking course might specify:

- The kinds of oral skills that will be taught and practiced during the course
- The functions
- Topics or other aspects of conversation that will be taught, and the order in which they will appear in the course

2. Define Curriculum design.

Curriculum development is a more comprehensive process than syllabus design. It includes the processes that are used to determine the needs of a group of learners, to develop aims or objectives for a program, to address the needs, to determine an appropriate syllabus, course structure, teaching methods, and materials, and finally, to carry out an evaluation of the language program that results from these processes.

3. Write Early Teaching Methods:

The following chronology illustrates with dates the periods of greatest dominance:

- Grammar Translation Method (1800-1900)
- Direct Method (1890-1930)
- Structural Method (1930-1960)
- Reading Method (1920-1950)
- Audiolingual Method (1950-1970)
- Situational Method (1950-1970)
- Communicative Approach (1970-present)

What is Simplicity and centrality principle for designing grammatical syllabus?

Simplicity and centrality: This recommends choosing structures that are simple and more central to the basic structure of the language than those that are complex and peripheral. By these criteria, the following would occur in an introductory-level English course:

- The train arrived. (Subject Verb)
- She is a journalist. (Subject Verb Complement)

What is PPP method?

A sequence of classroom activities that went from *Presentation*, to controlled *Practice*, to freer *Production* (the PPP method).

What is the goal of English for ESP?

In contrast to students learning English for general purposes for whom mastery of the language for its own sake or in order to pass a general examination is the primary goal, the ESP student is usually studying English in order to carry out a particular role such as that of a foreign student in an English-medium university, a flight attendant, a mechanic, or a doctor. Jupp and Hodlin (1975) describe the traditional pre-ESP response to this situation in the 1950s citing the example of a country that needs to teach foreign languages to key personnel dealing with trade or foreign business. Trainees are released for four hours daily for a year. Two language laboratories are equipped with materials and the trainees follow a state-of-the-art audiovisual course in spoken colloquial English‖ based on selection and gradation by structural criteria with some additional *situational language*. However, the course takes no account of functional communicative needs or the-learner‘s own immediate situation. The English setting is largely a matter of an English family and some English surroundings; there is certainly no attempt to teach the English ‗rules of use‘ in terms of situations and relationships. The concept of ‗spoken colloquial English‘ is one largely based upon a structural description of written English and without reference to functional uses and roles (Jupp and Hodlin 1975).

Difference between Register Analysis and Discourse Analysis .

Register analysis studies the language of such fields as journalism, medicine, or law for distinctive patterns of occurrence of vocabulary, verb forms, noun phrases, and tense usage.

The research process: The vocabulary is primarily verbs and nouns and is presented in a context which discusses the five steps of research: formulating, investigating, analysing, drawing conclusions and reporting results.

The vocabulary of analysis: It includes high-frequency and two-word verbs needed in order to present information in an organized sequence, for example, *consist of*, *group*, *result from*, *derive*, *base on*, *be noted for*, etc.

Discourse analysis examines the communicative contexts that affect language use, for example, in social transactions, the relationship between the discourse and the speakers and listeners.
For example, it looks at how the choice of verb tenses or other grammatical features affect the structure of the discourse. The analysis also looks at the relationship between utterances, for example, aspects of cohesion, and the discourse markers or cohesive devices that are employed.

Explain The Munby Model?

Munby (1978), in an influential book of the time, describes a systematic approach to needs analysis in ESP course design and focuses on two dimensions of needs analysis:
1) The procedures used to specify the target-level communicative competence of the student, and
2) Procedures for turning the infor-mation into a syllabus. The Munby model describes the kind of information needed to develop a profile of the learner‘s communicative needs. An example will illustrate how the model could be applied in carrying out a needs profile. If one were profiling the needs of restaurant staff such as waiters and waitresses, the following information might be revealed through applying the Munby model:

Personal: Who the employees are, their age, nationalities, sex, educational background, work experience.
Purpose: The kinds of outcomes expected such as the types of communicative skills the clients need to develop.
Setting: The type of restaurant in which the employees work and the kinds of customers who use the restaurant.
Interactional: The role and relationships such as waiter/waitress to variables customer, waiter/waitress to restaurant manager.
Medium/ mode: Whether spoken or written, face to face and channel dialects or both formal and casual styles.
Target level: Whether basic, intermediate, or advanced level.

Anticipated: For example, greetings, taking requests, clarifying communicative Information, describing menu items.
Key: For example, unhurriedly, quietly, politely.

Historical Background of Communicative Language Teaching (CLT)

CLT was a response to changes in the field of linguistics in the 1970s. It was also a response to the need for new approaches to language teaching in Europe as a result of initiative by groups such as the Council of Europe. Linguistics moved away from a focus on grammar as the core component of language abilities to a consideration of how language is used by speakers in different contexts of communication. The capacity to use language appropriately in communication based on the setting, the roles of the participants and the nature of the transaction was referred to as communicative competence. Applied linguists sought to apply this notion to language teaching. As a grammatical syllabus is based on the notion of grammatical competence (the knowledge people have of a language that underlies their capacities to produce and recognize sentences in the language), therefore, a different type of syllabus would be needed to teach communicative competence.

Situation Analysis:

Situation analysis is an analysis of factors in the context of a planned or present curriculum project that is made in order to assess their political, social, economic, or institutional situation. Situation analysis complements the information gathered during needs analysis.

Project Factors:

Curriculum projects are typically produced by a team of people. Members of the team may be specialists who are hired specifically for the purpose; they may be classroom teachers who are seconded to the project for a fixed period of time.

The following project factors need to be considered:

- Who constitutes the project group and how are they selected?
- What are the management and other responsibilities of the team?
- How are goals and procedures determined?
- Who reviews the progress of the project and performance of its members?
- What experience do members of the team have?
- How do members of the team regard each other?

Teacher Factors:

Teacher is a key factor in the successful implementation of curriculum changes. Exceptional teachers can often compensate for the poor-quality resources and materials they have to work from. But inadequately trained teachers may not be able to make effective use of teaching materials, no matter how well they are designed. In any institution, teachers may vary according to the following dimensions:

- Language proficiency

- Teaching experience
- Skill and expertise
- Training and qualifications
- Morale and motivation
- Teaching style
- Beliefs and principles

Constraints Effect Curriculum Design:

These constraints could have the following effects on curriculum design:

- Parents should be guided in giving their children some extra contact with English.
- The activities should be fun so that the children look forward to do them for their own sake.
- Some of the activities should carry over to the next class so that the children look forward to continue them.
- The activities should be largely teacher-centred rather than group or pair work.
- Most of the activities should be meaning-focused. Language-focused activities should mainly involve correction.

Environment Constraints:

Sometimes, it is necessary to consider wider aspects of the situation when carrying out an environment analysis. There may, for example, be institutional or government policies requiring the use of the target language in schools (Liu, 2004), or there may be negative attitudes towards the target language among learners in post-colonial societies. Dubin and Olshtain (1986) suggest a useful way of thinking about the wider environment that can have implications for language curriculum design.
For example, the language curriculum in a situation where the target language is recognized as one of a country‘s official languages (the political and national context) then there are relatively few native speakers (the language setting); there are relatively few opportunities to use the language outside the classroom (patterns of language use in society); majority-language speakers doubt the target language‘s contemporary relevance (group and individual attitudes) will differ greatly from that in a situation where the target language provides employment and educational opportunities.

Needs analysis:

Procedures used to collect information about learners‘ needs are known as needs analysis. Needs analysis, as a distinct and necessary phase in planning educational programs, emerged in the 1960s as a part of the systems approach to curriculum development.
Needs analysis in language teaching may be used for a number of different purposes, for example:

- To find out what language skills a learner needs in order to perform a particular role, such as sales manager, tour guide, or university student.

- To help determine if an existing course adequately addresses the needs of potential students.
- To determine which students from a group are most in need of training in particular language skills.
- To identify a change of direction that people in a reference group feel important.
- To identify a gap between what students are able to do and what they need to be able to do.
- To collect information about a particular problem learners are experiencing.

Explain the audience of needs analysis:

The Users of Needs Analysis

A needs analysis may be conducted for a variety of different users. For example, in conducting a needs analysis to help revise the secondary school English curriculum in a country, the end users include:

- Curriculum officers in the ministry of education who may wish to use the information to evaluate the adequacy of existing syllabus, curriculum, and materials.
- Teachers who will teach from the new curriculum.
- Learners who will be taught from the curriculum.
- Writers who are preparing new textbooks.
- Testing personnel who are involved in developing end-of-school assessments.
- Staff of tertiary institutions who are interested in knowing what the expected level of the existing students will be and what problems they face.

In cases of large-scale needs analysis, there will be multiple audiences for the results of a needs analysis.

Explain Target Population:

The target population in a needs analysis refers to the people about whom information will be collected. Typically, in language programs there will be language learners or potential language learners, but others are also often involved depending on whether they can provide information useful in meeting the purposes of the needs analysis. For example, in conducting a needs analysis to determine the focus of an English program in public secondary schools in an EFL context, the target population might include:

- policymakers
- ministry of education officials
- teachers
- students
- academics
- employers

Write divisions of Twenty Principles:

The principles have been divided into three groups.

- The first group of principles deals with **content and sequencing**. These principles are concerned with what goes into a language course and the order in which language items appear in the course. The aim of these principles is to make sure that the learners are gaining something useful from the course.

- The second group of principles deals with **format and presentation**. These principles are concerned with what actually happens in the classroom and during the learning.

- The third group of principles deals with **monitoring and assessment** and to some degree evaluation. In each of these groups, the principles have been ranked in order of their importance i.e. the first principle in the group is the most important of that group; the second principle is the next most important and so on.

Motivation Principle:

As much as possible, the learners should be interested and excited about learning the language and they should come to value this learning.
This principle stresses the importance of the learners' attitude to what they are studying. Motivation is a very important determinant of the amount of time, involvement and effect that learners give to learning. The best motivation is intrinsic‖, springing from within the learner, rather than extrinsic‖, coming from some outside integrative or instrumental reward. Intrinsic motivation can develop as a result of extrinsic motivation. Learning for reasons of gain can result in a genuine love of learning and involvement in the activity. If learners are not interested in learning, it is worthwhile beginning by looking at ways to attract them and involve them in learning

Four Strands Principle:

A course should include a roughly even balance of the four strands of meaning-focused input, language-focused learning, meaning-focused output and fluency activities.
This principle is concerned with the relative amount of time given to the four main strands of a language course – meaning-focused input; language focused learning, meaning-focused output and fluency development.
The rough rule of thumb is that on average equal time should be given to each of these four strands in the total language experience of the learner. That means that time in class and out of class can be considered if, during these times, the learner is gaining appropriate language activity that can be classified as fitting into these strands.

For example, if a learner is doing a lot of graded reading outside class time and is gaining truly comprehensible input outside of class time, this would mean that the time allocation for meaning-focused input could be met outside class and so the time in class could be given to language-focused learning, meaning-focused output and fluency development.

Fluency Principle:

A language course should provide activities aimed at increasing the fluency with which the learners can use the language they already know, both receptively and productively.
Fluency is a part of the skill goal of language learning. Fluency activities do not aim to teach new language items but aim to give the learner ready access to what is already known.
The importance of fluency in language use is highlighted in first-language research on the relationship between vocabulary learning and reading comprehension

From the point of view of fluency, this activity has these important features.

- First, the user is encouraged to process a large quantity of language.
- Second, the demands of the activity are limited to a much smaller set than would occur in most uncontrolled learning activities.
- Third, the learner is helped to reach a high level of performance.

Time on Task Principle:

As much time as possible should be spent on using and focusing on the second language.
This principle is based on the research finding that one of the best indicators of how much will be learned is how long the learners spend on appropriate learning activities. The more time learners spend on language learning, the more they learn. The principle gains some support from the correlation between lengths of time spent living in a country where the foreign language is spoken and proficiency in the language.

Learning Style principle:

There should be opportunity for learners to work with the learning material in ways that most suit their individual learning style.
Learners approach activities in a variety of ways depending on their personality, their previous learning experience, their expectations of how they will be tested on what they learn, and their view of the nature of the learning task.

The following list suggests some of the choices that could be made available:

- Group size: learning individually or with other learners
- Speed and intensity: learning at a slow, thoughtful pace or at a fast and intensive pace
- Medium: learning through aural input or written input
- Representation of information: learning through language or through pictorial or diagrammatic representation
- Mental process: learning holistically or through analysis
- Understanding: learning through doing or through understanding
- Use of first language: learning through translation or through the second

What is Cultural Pluralism?

This philosophy argues that schools should prepare students to participate in several different cultures and not merely the culture of the dominant social and economic group. This particular philosophy defines the role of schools where there is no inequality on the basis of gender, race or age. Learning is an inclusive process where roles of schools and learners are integrated.
Cultural pluralism defines the role of various cultures and to what extent it is important to look at the culture of the native speakers while designing the course. Cultural pluralism leads to the bilingual education in some parts of the world.
Banks (1983) argues that students in multicultural societies such as the United States need to develop cross-cultural competency or what is sometimes termed intercultural communication.

Aims and Objectives:

The purposes of aim statements are:

- To provide a clear definition of the purposes of a program.
- To provide guidelines for teachers, learners, and material writers.
- To help provide a focus for instruction.
- To describe important and realizable changes in learning.

Aims statements reflect the ideology of the curriculum and show how the curriculum will seek to realize it.

Objectives generally have the following characteristics:

- They describe what the aim seeks to achieve in terms of smaller units of learning.
- They provide a basis for the organization of teaching activities.
- They describe learning in terms of observable behavior or performance.

Criticism on Objectives:

1. This criticism is more applicable to the form of objectives known as behavioral objectives. To ensure that the curriculum addresses educationally important goals, objectives should be in-cluded that address meaningful and worthwhile learning experiences. One way to do this is to include objectives that cover both language outcomes and non-language outcomes.

2. Objectives need not to be limited to observable outcomes. They can also describe processes and experiences that are seen as an important focus of the curriculum.

Objective turn teaching into technology

3. Objectives are unsuited to many aspects of language use. Objectives may be suitable for describing the mastery of skills, but less suited to such things as critical thinking, literary appreciation, or negotiation of meaning.

4. Objectives can be written in domains such as critical thinking and literary thinking but will focus on the experiences the curriculum will provide rather than specific learning outcomes.

Objective are trivialize teaching and are product oriented

Competency-Based Language Teaching (CBLT):

CBLT seeks to make a focus on the outcomes of learning, a central planning stage in the development of language programs. Traditionally, in language teaching planners have focused to a large extent on the content of teaching (as reflected in a concern for different types of syllabuses) or on the process of teaching (as reflected in a concern for different types of teaching methods). Critics of this approach argue that this concern with content or process focuses on the means of learning rather than its ends. CBLT shifts the focus to the ends of learning rather than the means. As a general educational and training approach, CBLT seeks to improve accountability in teaching through using instruction to measurable outcomes and performance standards.

First emergence of CBLT:

CBLT first emerged in the United States in the 1970s and was widely adopted in vocationally oriented education and in adult ESL programs. By the end of the 1980s, CBLT had come to be accepted as "the state-of-the-art approach to adult ESL by national policymakers and leaders in curriculum development as well" (Auerbach 1986). In 1986, any refugee in the United States who wished to receive federal assistance had to be enrolled in a competency-based program (Auerbach 1986). CBLT has recently re-emerged in some parts of the world (e.g., Australia) as the major approach to the planning of language programs.

Situational syllabus:

It is organized around the language needed for different situations such as at the airport or at a hotel. A situation is a setting in which particular communicative acts typically occur. A situational syllabus identifies the situations in which the learner will use the language and the typical communicative acts and language used in that setting. Situational syllabuses have been a familiar feature of language teaching textbooks for centuries (Kelly, 1969) and are often used in travel books and books that focus on mastering expressions frequently encountered in particular situations.

Lexical syllabus:

It identifies a target vocabulary to be taught, normally arranged according to levels such as the first 500, 1,000, 1,500, 2,000 words. Vocabulary syllabuses were among the first types of syllabuses to be developed in language teaching. Today, there is a large degree of consensus in English-language teaching concerning targets for vocabulary teaching at different levels and textbook and materials; writers tend to keep materials within target vocabulary bands.

Units of Progression:

Discourse as the basis for units of progression is more likely to be used in pre university courses where learners systematically cover a range of relevant genres such as recounts, information reports and arguments. Attention to elements of spoken discourse, such as ellipsis between speakers and negotiation of discourse, may occur early in language courses but is rarely the unit of progression for a course.

Subskills:

There are three major ways of defining subskills. One is to look at the range of activities covered by a skill such as speaking and to use these as a starting point for defining subskills. For example, speaking can be divided into interactional speaking and transactional speaking (Brown, 1978). Transactional speaking can be divided into monologue, dialogue, etc.

Six levels of Bloom's:

The most well-known approach of this kind can be found in what is popularly known as Bloom's taxonomy. Bloom divides cognitive activity into six levels of increasing complexity:

- knowledge
- Comprehension
- Application
- Analysis
- Synthesis
- Evaluation

These levels have often been applied to the construction of reading comprehension activities.

Categories of Ideas Content of a course:

The ideas content of a course can take many forms. The following list is adapted from Cook (1983). The ideas about the content of a course can be as under:

1. Imaginary happenings: The course could follow the typical activities or adventures of a group of learners or native speakers.
2. An academic subject: Examples would be linguistics or the special purpose of the learners such as agriculture, tourism, commerce or computing.
3. Learner survival needs: These can arise from suggestions by the learners or investigation by the teacher. They may include topics like shopping, going to the doctor, getting a driver‘s licence, and making friends. Ek and Alexander (1980) provide a detailed list of topics under 14 main headings covering daily use of language.

4. Interesting facts: These might include topics like the discovery of penicillin, whales and solar power.
5. Culture: Adaskou, Britten and Fahsi (1990) divide culture into aesthetic which includes the study of literature, sociological which looks at norms of behaviour and cultural values, semantic which looks

Task-Based Syllabus

A task is an activity which requires learners to use language, with emphasis on meaning, to attain an objective.
With the shift to communicative language teaching in the 1970s there was an increasing emphasis on using language to convey a message, and as a result increasing attention was given to the use of tasks in the classroom. Published experimentation with task-based syllabuses largely began with the work of Prabhu (1987), and the interest in this type of syllabus may be a result of the links that teachers and curriculum designers see between this approach and their own teaching and planning activity.

Meaning Focused speaking:

Meaning-focused speaking should involve the learners in conversation and also in monologue. The conversation can have a largely social focus and can also be used for conveying important information. That is, there should be practice in both interactional and transactional language use. The conditions for meaning-focused output are similar to those for meaning-focused input. There should be a focus on the message (that is getting the listener or the reader to understand), the task should be demanding but not too demanding, and there should be plenty of opportunity for such activity.

Phases of Task based learning:

Willis (1996) describes the task-based learning framework as consisting of three phases: pre-task, the task cycle and language focus. Considerable variety and variation are possible within this framework, and the task need not focus on a specific language structure.

Mission Statement:

A useful format for articulating a school's sense of mission is in the form of a mission statement. Such a statement should be developed collectively by those who have a commitment to the success of the institution. Once it is developed, a mission statement can serve as a reference point to assess proposals for new initiatives or programs within an institution and to provide a basis for evaluation of its performance over time.

Organizational Factors of institute that effect quality of teaching:

Factors relevant to creating a culture of quality assurance in an institution are as follows:

- A formulated policy on quality assurance has been articulated and is familiar to all staff.
- Reasonable and acceptable standards have been determined for all aspects of quality, such as employment, publicity, materials, facilities, and teachers‘ dress codes.
- Systems in place to ensure that quality are regularly assessed and corrections are made where necessary.
- A reward system is in place to ensure that those who attain high quality in their work are recognized.

Features of a Sound Curriculum:

A sound curriculum is reflected in the following features of a school's programs:

- The range of courses offered corresponds to the needs of learners.
- The curriculum is coherent: The courses represent a rational approach to achieve the school's mission.
- Courses have been developed based on sound educational principles with due attention to recognized curriculum development processes.
- Course descriptions including aims, goals, syllabuses, and course organization, have been developed.
- Teaching materials and tests are of high quality. They have been carefully selected or developed, and are regularly reviewed and revised.

Quality Teaching:

Good quality teaching can affect the whole structure of an organization. The internal communication needs to be transparent and clear between administrations, teachers, and supporting staff. There are various factors to ensure the transparency of the system:

- Regular meetings
- Transparent admin system

- Shared decision making
- Clear guidance for staff
- Feedback on program aspects
- Regular communication
- Informal gatherings

In ESL domain, teachers need to have special skills and expertise. In order to ensure good internal communication, it is important to give teachers professional treatment like reward and guidance about the teachers‘ role and responsibilities.

Ongoing Support for Teachers:

If teachers are expected to teach well and to develop their teaching skills and knowledge over time, they need ongoing support. This may take a number of forms:

- Orientation
- Adequate materials
- Course guides
- Division of responsibilities
- Further training
- Teaching release
- Mentors
- Feedback

The Learning Process:

Learning is not the mirror image of teaching. The extent to which teaching achieves its goals will also dependent on how successfully learners have been considered in the planning and delivery process. The following factors may affect how successfully a course is received by learners:

- Understanding of the course
- Views of learning
- Learning styles
- Motivation
- Support

Printed and Non-Printed materials:

- **Printed materials** such as books, workbooks, worksheets, or reader

- **Non-printed materials** such as cassette or audio materials, videos, or computer-based materials
- **Materials that comprise print and non-print s**ources such as self-access materials and materials on the Internet. In addition, materials that are not designed for instructional use such as magazines, newspapers, and TV materials may also play a role in the curriculum.

Authentic materials:

Authentic materials refer to the use in teaching of texts, photographs, video selections, and other teaching resources that were not specially prepared for pedagogical purposes.

Advantages claimed for authentic materials are:

- They have a positive effect on learners‘ motivation because they are intrinsically more interesting and motivating than created materials
- They provide authentic information about the target culture.
- They provide exposure to real language rather than the artificial texts found in created materials that have been specially written to illustrate particular grammatical rules or discourse types.
- They relate more closely to learners' needs and hence provide a link between the classroom and students' needs in the real world.
- They support a more creative approach to teaching. In using authentic materials as a source for teaching activities, teachers can develop their full potential as teachers, developing activities and tasks that better match their teaching styles and the learning styles of their students.

Created Materials:

Created materials refer to textbooks and other specially developed instructional resources. Critics of the use of authentic materials point out that created materials can also be motivating for learners. Created materials may be superior to authentic materials because they are generally built around a graded syllabus and hence provide a systematic coverage of teaching items.
Using authentic materials is a burden for teachers. In many language programs, teachers thus use a mixture of created and authentic materials because both have their advantages as well as limitations.

Criteria for Textbook Evaluation:

Cunningsworth (1995) proposes four criteria for evaluating textbooks, particularly course books:

1. They should correspond to learners' needs. They should match the aims and objectives of the language learning program.

2. They should reflect the uses (present or future) that learners will make of the language. Textbooks should be chosen that will help equip students to use language effectively for their own purposes.

3. They should take account of students' needs as learners and should facilitate their learning processes, without dogmatically imposing a rigid method.

4. They should have a clear role as a support for learning. Like teachers, they mediate between the target language and the learner.

